

“…WHAT SHALL BE OUR ENDEAVOUR? TO BRING FREEDOM AND OPPORTUNITY TO THE COMMON MAN, TO THE PEASANTS AND WORKERS OF INDIA; TO FIGHT AND END POVERTY AND IGNORANCE AND DISEASE; TO BUILD UP A PROSPEROUS, DEMOCRATIC AND PROGRESSIVE NATION, AND TO CREATE SOCIAL, ECONOMIC AND POLITICAL INSTITUTIONS WHICH WILL ENSURE JUSTICE AND FULLNESS OF LIFE…”

Leading by example

Jawaharlal Nehru was born in Allahabad (present-day Prayagraj) to Motilal Nehru, a successful barrister, and his wife Swarup Rani. Young Jawaharlal’s upbringing was more in keeping with British than Indian norms: he was first tutored at home, and then spent several years in England at Harrow (a prestigious boys’ school), the University of Cambridge and in London. He returned to India in 1912. His father was one of the leaders of the Congress, and Nehru soon began to work alongside him in the nationalist movement. The family home in Allahabad became a centre of anti-colonial activity and